

The 12-bar blues map every chord option in 18 forms, simplest first

Any key: I is the key chord

Bars 1–4
I, or something
standing in for it

I7	1
IΔ7	1–9
#i–7 #IV7	10–15 17
I9sus	16
	18

I7	2
IV7	1 2
vii–7 bVII–7	3–9
IVΔ7	11
vii–7 III7	12 13
#i–7 #IV7	10 14–16
IV9sus	17
	18

I7	3
vi–7 bvi–7	1–9
iii–7 ii–7	11
vi–7 II7	12 13
VIIΔ7 bVIIΔ7	10 14–16
I9sus	17
	18

I7	4
v–7 I7	1–6
v–7 #IV7	7–10 14 16
#i–7 #IV7	11
bVIIΔ7 #IVΔ7	12 13 15
I9sus	17
	18

Bars 5–8
IV, then back
toward I

IV7	5
IVΔ7	1–10
IV9sus	11–17
	18

IV7	6
bVII7	1–5
#iv°7	6–8
iv–7	10
#iv–7 VII7	11 12
iv–7 bVII7	9 17
iv–7 VII7	13 14 16
IV9sus	15
	18

I7	7
I7 VII7	1–7
iii–7 VI7	9
iii–7	10
bIIIΔ7	8 11 12 14 15
IIIΔ7	13 16
I9sus	17
	18

I7	8
VI7	1–3
bVII7 VI7	4–6 8
biii–7	9
iii–7 VI7	11 12
biii–7 bVI7	7 17
I9sus	10 13–16
	18

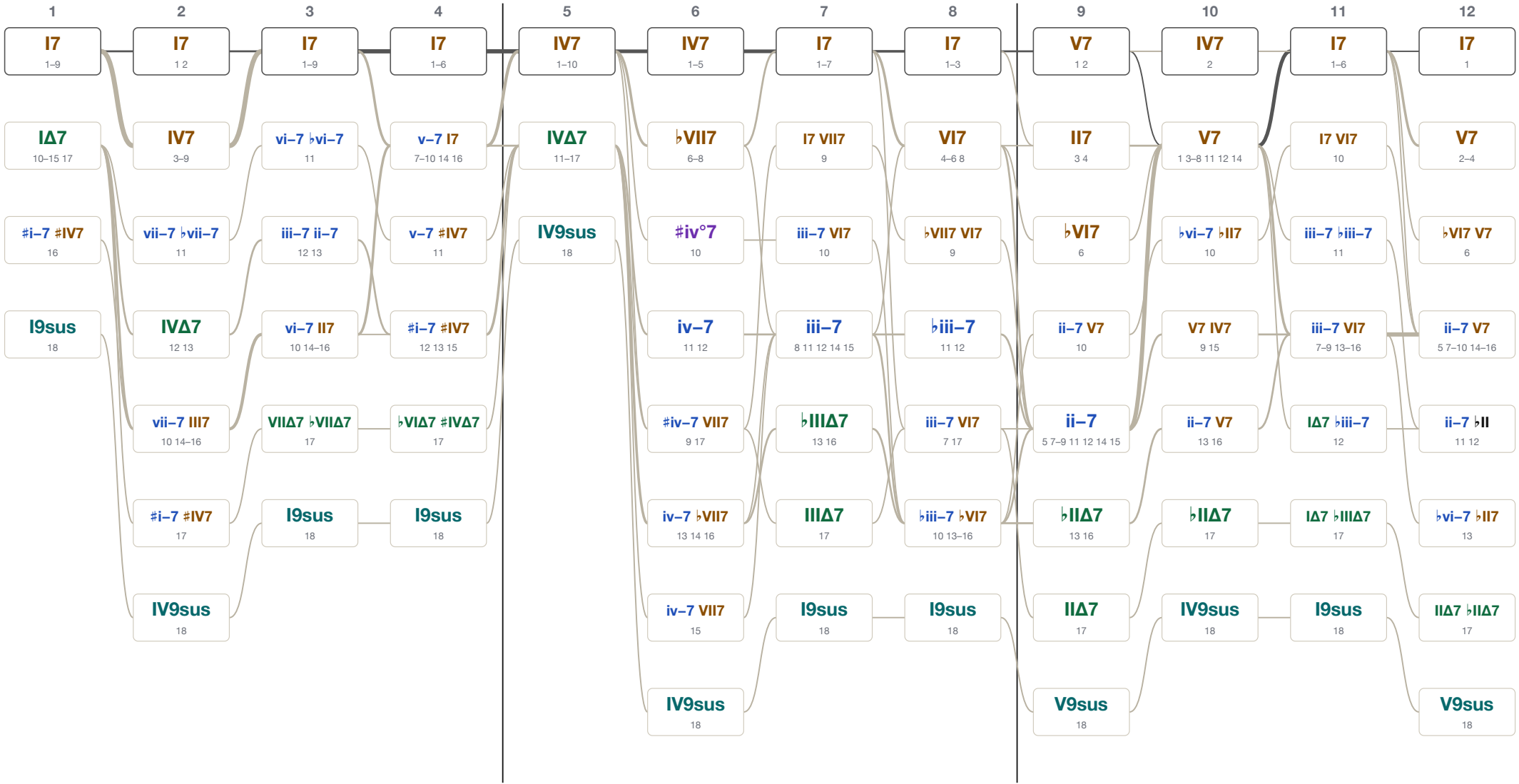
Bars 9–12
V (or a ii–V),
home to I

V7	9
II7	1 2
bVI7	3 4
ii–7 V7	6
ii–7	10
bIIΔ7	5 7–9 11 12 14 15
IIΔ7	13 16
V9sus	17
	18

IV7	10
V7	2
bvi–7 bII7	1 3–8 11 12 14
V7 IV7	10
ii–7 V7	9 15
bIIΔ7	13 16
IV9sus	17
	18

I7	11
I7 VI7	1–6
iii–7 biii–7	10
iii–7 VI7	11
IΔ7 biii–7	7–9 13–16
IΔ7 bIIIΔ7	12
I9sus	17
	18

I7	12
V7	1
bVI7 V7	2–4
ii–7 V7	6
ii–7 bII	5 7–10 14–16
bvi–7 bII7	11 12
IIΔ7 bIIΔ7	13
V9sus	17
	18



The 18 forms

bold: changed from the row above

Any key: I is the key chord

Form	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
1 Basic blues	I7	I7	I7	I7	IV7	IV7	I7	I7	V7	V7	I7	I7
2 V–IV cadence	I7	I7	I7	I7	IV7	IV7	I7	I7	V7	IV7	I7	V7
3 Quick four + II7	I7	IV7	I7	I7	IV7	IV7	I7	I7	II7	V7	I7	V7
4 VI7–II7–V7 chain	I7	IV7	I7	I7	IV7	IV7	I7	VI7	II7	V7	I7	V7
5 Diatonic ii–V	I7	IV7	I7	I7	IV7	IV7	I7	VI7	ii–7	V7	I7	ii–7 V7
6 IV of IV + tritone subs	I7	IV7	I7	I7	IV7	bVII7	I7	VI7	bVI7	V7	I7	bVI7 V7
7 ii–V into IV; iii–VI–ii–V	I7	IV7	I7	v–7 I7	IV7	bVII7	I7	iii–7 VI7	ii–7	V7	iii–7 VI7	ii–7 V7
8 iii– in bar 7	I7	IV7	I7	v–7 I7	IV7	bVII7	iii–7	VI7	ii–7	V7	iii–7 VI7	ii–7 V7
9 Chromatic dominants	I7	IV7	I7	v–7 I7	IV7	#iv–7 VII7	I7 VII7	bVII7 VI7	ii–7	V7 IV7	iii–7 VI7	ii–7 V7
10 Bird blues	IΔ7	vii–7 III7	vi–7 II7	v–7 I7	IV7	#iv°7	iii–7 VI7	biii–7 bVI7	ii–7 V7	bvi–7 bII7	I7 VI7	ii–7 V7
11 Chromatic minor sevenths	IΔ7	vii–7 bvii–7	vi–7 bvi–7	v–7 #IV7	IVΔ7	iv–7	iii–7	biii–7	ii–7	V7	iii–7 biii–7	ii–7 bII
12 Major sevenths + chromatic minors	IΔ7	IVΔ7	iii–7 ii–7	#i–7 #IV7	IVΔ7	iv–7	iii–7	biii–7	ii–7	V7	IΔ7 biii–7	ii–7 bII
13 ii–Vs to bIII and bII	IΔ7	IVΔ7	iii–7 ii–7	#i–7 #IV7	IVΔ7	iv–7 bVII7	bIIIAΔ7	biii–7 bVI7	bIIAΔ7	ii–7 V7	iii–7 VI7	bvi–7 bII7
14 Blues for Alice style	IΔ7	vii–7 III7	vi–7 II7	v–7 I7	IVΔ7	iv–7 bVII7	iii–7	biii–7 bVI7	ii–7	V7	iii–7 VI7	ii–7 V7
15 Tritone-sub ii–V into IV	IΔ7	vii–7 III7	vi–7 II7	#i–7 #IV7	IVΔ7	iv–7 VII7	iii–7	biii–7 bVI7	ii–7	V7 IV7	iii–7 VI7	ii–7 V7
16 ii–V chain from bar 1	#i–7 #IV7	vii–7 III7	vi–7 II7	v–7 I7	IVΔ7	iv–7 bVII7	bIIIAΔ7	biii–7 bVI7	bIIAΔ7	ii–7 V7	iii–7 VI7	ii–7 V7
17 Major-seventh planing	IΔ7	#i–7 #IV7	VIIAΔ7 bVIIAΔ7	bVIAΔ7 #IVAΔ7	IVΔ7	#iv–7 VII7	IIIAΔ7	iii–7 VI7	IIAΔ7	bIIAΔ7	IΔ7 bIIIAΔ7	IIAΔ7 bIIAΔ7
18 Sus-chord blues	I9sus	IV9sus	I9sus	I9sus	IV9sus	IV9sus	I9sus	I9sus	V9sus	IV9sus	I9sus	V9sus